Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role at Halden Pay. Over nine years in data engineering, I have built and operated batch and streaming platforms across logistics, payments and retail, with a focus on dependable pipelines, clear data contracts and data that downstream teams can trust.

In my current role, I own the ingestion layer of a data platform spanning approximately 140 Airflow DAGs and sources including Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs, with data loaded into Snowflake. I moved transformation logic to dbt, building more than 420 tested models and reducing the nightly run from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I also introduced JSON Schema contracts with CI checks, which reduced broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine per month to two. These experiences align closely with your focus on owning a shared platform, building reusable frameworks and defining data quality standards.

I have also worked with large-scale event and cloud data workloads: a Kafka-based shipment tracking pipeline processing approximately 30 million events per day, and PySpark reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files daily. My warehouse experience includes designing a Redshift dimensional schema with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams. Across these roles, I have worked to turn the needs of product, finance and risk colleagues into reliable data capabilities, and I bring hands-on experience with Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Docker and CI checks.

Halden Pay's emphasis on a shared Data Platform team and reusable solutions is a strong fit for the platform work I have led. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience in platform ownership, data modelling and operational data quality could contribute to the team.

Sincerely, Lena Varga-Holm